



PROTESTERS in L.A. pray in memory of Renee Nicole Good, who was killed by an ICE agent in Minneapolis.

Slaying by ICE a test of Trump policy

Despite public outcry, White House vows to send even more agents to Minnesota.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — When a 37-year-old mother of three was fatally shot by an immigration agent Wednesday morning, driving in her Minneapolis neighborhood after dropping her son off at school, the Trump administration's response was swift. The victim was to blame for her own death — acting as a “professional agitator,” a “domestic terrorist,” possibly trained to use her car against law enforcement, officials said.

It was an uncompromising response without any pretense the administration would rely on independent investigations of the event, video of which quickly circulated online, gripping the nation. “You can accept that this woman's death is a tragedy,” Vice President JD Vance wrote on social media, defending the shooting by an Immigration and Customs Enforcement agent within hours of her death, “while acknowledging it's a tragedy of her own making.”

The shooting of Renee Nicole Good, an American citizen, put the administration on defense over one of President Trump's signature policy initiatives, exponentially expanding the ranks of ICE to outnumber most armies, and deploying its agents across unassuming communities throughout the United States.

ICE had just announced the deployment of “the largest immigration operation ever” in the Minnesota city, allegedly targeting Somali residents involved in fraud schemes. But Good's death could prove a turning point. The shooting has highlighted souring public opinion on Trump's immigration enforcement, with a majority of Americans now disapproving of the administration's tactics, according to Pew Research.

Despite the outcry, Trump's team doubled down on Thursday, vowing to send even more agents to [See Minneapolis, A5]

Minnesota wants role in inquiry

Gov. Tim Walz demands that the FBI and Justice Department work with state officials. **NATION A4**

Senate weighs war powers

Dissent grows within GOP as Trump and Miller escalate rhetoric on seizing Greenland by force

By ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — Five Senate Republicans broke with party leaders on Thursday to advance legislation that would rein in President Trump's use of the U.S. military in Venezuela, a move that comes as a growing number of GOP lawmakers have expressed unease about the White House's threats to use force to acquire Greenland.

The procedural vote, which came over the objections of Republican leaders, sets the stage for a full Senate vote next week on a measure that would block Trump from using military force “within or against Venezuela” without approval from Congress.

Even with the Senate's approval, the legislation is unlikely to become law as it is unlikely to pass the House, and President Trump — who has veto power over legislation — has publicly condemned the measure and the Republicans who supported it.

“This vote greatly hampers American Self Defense and National Security, impeding the President's Authority as Com-

mander in Chief,” Trump wrote in a social media post shortly after the 52-47 vote in the Senate.

The Republican defection on the issue underscores the growing concern among GOP lawmakers over the Trump administration's foreign policy ambitions and highlights the bipartisan concern that the president is testing the limits of executive war powers — not only in Venezuela but also in Greenland, a semiautonomous territory of Denmark, a U.S. ally.

Sen. Susan Collins (R-Maine), one of the Republicans who voted for the resolution, said that although she supported the operation that led to the capture and extradition of Venezuelan leader Nicolás Maduro, she did not “support committing additional U.S. forces or entering into any long-term military involvement in Venezuela or Greenland without specific congressional authorization.”

The resolution is co-sponsored by Sens. Adam Schiff (D-Calif.), Tim Kaine (D-Va.) and Rand Paul (R-Ky.) and Sen-

[See Senate, A6]

A ‘narco-terrorism’ kingpin? Experts doubt it

By KEVIN RECTOR

In explaining the U.S. incursion into Venezuela to capture President Nicolás Maduro, President Trump accused Maduro and his wife of conducting a “campaign of deadly narco-terrorism against the United States and its citizens,” and Maduro of being “the kingpin of a vast criminal network responsible for trafficking colossal amounts of deadly and illicit drugs into the United States.”

“Hundreds of thousands — over the years — of Americans died because of him,” Trump said hours after U.S. special forces dragged Maduro from his bedroom during a raid that killed more than 50 Venezuelan and Cuban military and security forces.

There's little evidence of Trump's claim the deposed Maduro caused hundreds of thousands of deaths



XNY/Star Max/GC Images

NICOLÁS MADURO, Venezuela's captured president, arrives in Manhattan in handcuffs on Monday.

Despite state's fiscal outlook, Newsom paints a bright picture

He touts successes, contrasts California and nation's capital in State of State speech.

By MELODY GUTIERREZ, KATIE KING AND DAKOTA SMITH

SACRAMENTO — In his final State of the State address, Gov. Gavin Newsom shifted from the problem-solving posture that defined his early years in office to a more declarative accounting of California's achievements, casting the state as a counterweight to dysfunction in Washington.

The address, which Newsom gave Thursday to a joint session of the Legislature, served as a capstone to his governorship, emphasizing policy results that included falling homelessness, lower crime rates and expanded education spending.

Delivered in the state Capitol, which was teeming with staffers, reporters and lawmakers, the speech marked Newsom's first in-person address to the Legislature in five years — a return some lawmakers have vocally pressed for — and offered a glimpse of how he is positioning himself for a potential run for president.

“In California, we're not silent,” Newsom said. “You're not hunkering down. We're not retreating. We're a beacon. This state is providing a different narrative. An operational model, a policy blueprint for others to follow.”

But the confident tone of the address lands against conflicting fiscal forecasts for the state. In November, the nonpartisan Legislative Analyst's Office warned that California faces a nearly \$18-billion budget shortfall.

Although the governor's Department of Finance does not always agree with the legislative analyst's estimates, such a deep financial hole threatened to complicate Newsom's final year of major policy decisions and diminish his national political appeal. Newsom, however, said his administration expects revenues to be \$42.3 billion higher over the next three fiscal years than was forecast last year. Part of that windfall will be used to increase per-pupil funding at public schools and also to pay down the state's pension obligations.

“Why? Because our economy is growing, our population is growing,” Newsom said of the revenue turnaround.

Republicans were quick to question whether the address focused on the state's outlook for the year ahead, as intended, or served as a campaign warm-up, noting that Newsom made no mention of the legislative analyst's warning about a looming budget shortfall.

State Sen. Tony Strickland (R-Huntington Beach) said Newsom's speech was “largely directed at the Trump administration, largely directed at national issues.”

“That was more of a cam-

[See Newsom, A8]

A power shift for state's schools?

Newsom proposes an overhaul to give future governors more say in education. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

California as a foil to Trump policies

Governor casts the state as a model for the nation, while his Republican foes criticize it. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

California students hit record high at UC

By JAWEED KALEEM

The University of California enrolled a record number of Californians in fall 2025 and saw a surge in new international students, touting the vitality and popularity of a system under attack by the Trump administration and grappling with federal funding cuts and recent years of state budget belt-tightening.

More than 301,000 students attended one of UC's 10 campuses over the fall — the largest number in its history — according to data released Thursday, with a year-over-year increase of 1,686 students. The total included more than 200,000 California resident undergraduates, an increase of 1,796 students.

At 42,232, first-year California undergraduates made up about 80% of the total 52,611 first-year students, an increase of 264 from 2024.

“These numbers reflect California's commitment to academic excellence, access, and innovation, values that have made the University of California the world's greatest research university,” UC

[See UC, A8]

State led nation in layoffs in 2025

Tumult in tech and film sectors drove the cuts. Only D.C. took a bigger hit. **BUSINESS, A10**

Herbert ignores pain for the gain

Not even a broken left hand can keep Chargers quarterback from a playoff spot. **SPORTS, B10**

Directors Guild picks nominees

Paul Thomas Anderson, Chloé Zhao and Ryan Coogler among finalists. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather
Sunshine.
L.A. Basin: 67/54. **B6**

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